Acme Corporation — Employee Handbook

Human Resources Policy Document · Version 1.0 · Effective January 1, 2026

1. Welcome and Purpose

Welcome to Acme Corporation. This Employee Handbook describes the policies, benefits, and standards of conduct that apply to all employees. It is intended as a general guide and does not constitute an employment contract.

Where a specific policy document (such as the Leave Policy) provides more detailed rules on a topic covered briefly here, that dedicated policy takes precedence.

2. Employment Basics

2.1 Employment Classification

Employees are classified as full-time (35+ hours per week), part-time, or temporary/contract. Classification determines eligibility for certain benefits as described in Section 3.

2.2 Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a 30-minute unpaid lunch break. Departments with different operational needs may set alternative schedules with HR approval.

Employees are expected to notify their manager as soon as possible if they will be late or unable to attend work for reasons other than pre-approved leave.

2.3 Overtime

Non-exempt employees who work beyond 40 hours in a week are eligible for overtime pay at 1.5 times their regular hourly rate, subject to prior manager approval. Exempt (salaried) employees are not eligible for overtime pay but may be granted compensatory time off at manager discretion.

> **EXAMPLE**
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> *Maria, a non-exempt customer support associate, works 44 hours in a week with her manager's approval. She is paid her regular rate for 40 hours and 1.5x her rate for the additional 4 hours.*

3. Compensation and Benefits

3.1 Payroll and Pay Schedule

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis via direct deposit. Pay statements are available through the HR portal on the Wednesday preceding each pay date.

3.2 Health Insurance

Full-time employees are eligible for company-subsidized health, dental, and vision insurance starting on the first day of the month following 30 days of employment. The Company covers 80% of the premium for employee-only coverage.

3.3 Retirement Savings Plan

Employees may enroll in the Company's retirement savings plan after 90 days of employment. The Company matches employee contributions up to 4% of base salary.

3.4 Other Perks

Additional benefits include an annual $500 learning and development stipend, a $50 monthly wellness allowance, and an employee assistance program providing confidential counseling services.

4. Code of Conduct

4.1 Professional Behavior

Employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism at all times, both in the workplace and at company-sponsored events.

4.2 Anti-Harassment and Non-Discrimination

The Company maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind based on race, gender, age, religion, disability, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic. Employees who experience or witness such conduct should report it to HR immediately; all reports are treated confidentially and investigated promptly.

4.3 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose to HR any outside employment, financial interest, or personal relationship that could reasonably be seen to conflict with the Company's interests, including relationships with vendors, competitors, or direct reports.

4.4 Confidentiality

Employees must not disclose confidential business information, trade secrets, or personal data of employees or customers to any unauthorized party, both during and after their employment with the Company.

5. Workplace Policies

5.1 Dress Code

The Company follows a business-casual dress code on standard working days. Employees meeting with external clients or attending formal events should dress in business professional attire. Casual dress, including jeans, is permitted on Fridays.

5.2 Remote and Hybrid Work

Employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week with manager approval. Fully remote arrangements require sign-off from a department VP and are evaluated on a case-by-case basis considering role requirements and team needs.

- Remote work days must be logged in the HR portal.
- Employees are expected to be reachable during core hours (10:00 AM–4:00 PM) regardless of work location.
- The Company is not responsible for providing home office furniture, but offers a one-time $200 home office stipend for new hires.

5.3 Use of Company Property and IT Systems

Company equipment, email, and IT systems are provided for business use. Limited personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work responsibilities or violate the Acceptable Use Policy maintained by the IT department.

5.4 Health and Safety

The Company is committed to maintaining a safe working environment in compliance with applicable workplace safety regulations. Employees must report any safety hazards, accidents, or near-misses to their manager and the Facilities team immediately.

6. Performance and Development

6.1 Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year, in June and December. Reviews assess progress against agreed goals and inform decisions on compensation, promotion, and development planning.

6.2 Training and Development

Employees are encouraged to pursue professional development opportunities relevant to their role, supported by the annual learning stipend described in Section 3.4 and internal training programs offered throughout the year.

6.3 Disciplinary Process

Performance or conduct concerns are typically addressed through an informal conversation in the first instance. Where issues persist, the Company follows a progressive disciplinary process: verbal warning, written warning, final written warning, and, if necessary, termination. Serious misconduct (such as theft, harassment, or safety violations) may result in immediate termination without progressing through earlier steps.

7. Separation from Employment

7.1 Resignation

Employees who wish to resign are asked to provide at least 4 weeks' written notice to their manager and HR, to allow for an orderly handover of responsibilities.

7.2 Termination

The Company may terminate employment for reasons including, but not limited to, performance, conduct, or business restructuring, in accordance with applicable employment law and the disciplinary process described in Section 6.3.

7.3 Exit Process

Departing employees are required to return all Company property, including laptops, access cards, and any physical documents, on or before their last day. HR will schedule an exit interview to gather feedback and confirm final pay and benefits details.